

Food Systems Summit Stocktaking Moment 2023

The Food Systems Summit Stocktaking Moment will be held between 24 - 26 July 2023 at FAO Headquarters in Rome. This high-level meeting will be an opportunity to review progress in achieving healthier, more sustainable and more resilient food systems.

In September 2021 the United Nations (UN) hosted a [Food Systems Summit](#). The Summit was preceded by a series of events that brought together policymakers, farmers, industry, academia and community groups from around the world, to discuss challenges and share potential solutions and innovations.

As a UN member, Australia participated in these events. The Department of Agriculture, Water and the Environment (DAWE) - now the Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry (DAFF) - was the lead agency for Australian Government engagement.

The aim of the Summit was to raise awareness of the critical role that agricultural and food systems play in achieving a sustainable future. Outcomes will go towards achieving the [Sustainable Development Goals \(SDG's\)](#) through healthier, more sustainable and more resilient food systems.

Food systems

Food systems include all people, processes and activities involved in the production, aggregation, processing, distribution, consumption and disposal of food products from agriculture, forestry and fisheries, and the broader economic, social and environmental contexts in which these activities take place (FAO, 2018). Food systems are complex and interconnected.

The world's food systems are facing many challenges, including here in Australia. There is a need to:

- feed more people
- ensure more sustainable food production
- enable farmers and producers to make a decent living from agriculture.

Reducing hunger and malnutrition around the world and managing risks from climate change are also key global challenges.

Australia's participation in the Summit

Australia supports the UN's goal of delivering more sustainable, productive and resilient agricultural and food systems for producers and consumers alike.

Australia has developed and implemented a wide range of policies, programs and initiatives to continue to improve the sustainability and resilience of our food systems across the agricultural, environmental, manufacturing and health sectors. These included the Ag2030 Plan, the National Food Waste Strategy, the Agriculture Stewardship Package, the National Climate Resilience and Adaptation Strategy, and efforts to modernise the food regulation system.

Through the CSIRO, Australia is developing the Food System Horizons initiative with the University of Queensland. This initiative will build capacity in Australia to navigate, manage and direct transformational processes aligned to the nation's food system priorities and ambitions.

Australia continues to engage in fora which support the core deliverables of the Summit. Australia is an active member of the UN Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO) and contributes to policies to develop better food systems.

The Food Systems [Pre-Summit event](#) was held in Rome on 26-28 July 2021, both face-to-face and virtual.

With participation from over 145 countries, the event set the stage for the final event in September by bringing together diverse actors from around the world to consider levers for change to help achieve all 17 SDGs by 2030. The Pre-Summit recognised the clear message from the 1000 dialogues involving over 50,000 people – that solutions and actions have to be tailored to local and regional contexts so there is no one size solution to fit all.

The [Food Systems Summit](#) was held virtually in New York on 23 and 24 September.

The Summit sought to generate significant action and measurable progress towards the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development by identifying solutions and leaders, and issued a call for action at all levels of the food system, including national and local governments, companies and citizens.

In the lead up to the Food Systems Summit UN member countries, including Australia, held National [Food Systems Summit Dialogues](#).

These webinars provided an independent platform for Australian stakeholders including experts, academics, industry representatives, farmers and the general public to share experiences, ideas, opportunities and solutions on a variety of issues and challenges facing agricultural and food systems.

The aim was for the discussion to be open and transparent, and as representative as possible. They were independent of Australian Government processes and views.

Feedback from the dialogues formed a key part of Australia's input into the Food Systems Pre-Summit and Summit.

This table summarises previous National Food Systems Summit Dialogues held by the Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry and provides links to webinar recordings and transcripts.

Webinar and date	Discussion topics	Presenters	Recording and transcript
Growing Greener – food production and a healthy environment 13 May 2021			
Future proofing our food systems – boosting resilience 20 May 2021			

Eating for our health and the environment -
balancing nutrition and sustainability 27 May 2021

Australian Food Systems – addressing shared
challenges 9 June 2021

Agricultural innovation – building better food
systems 13 July 2021

Additional National Food Systems Summit dialogues convened by other Australian Government departments and agencies include:

Multi-stakeholder Partnerships for Scaling Agricultural Innovation

Convened on 25 May 2021 by the Australian Centre for International Agricultural Research (ACIAR) and the Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade (DFAT).

[This dialogue](#) brought together high-level stakeholders from around the world to discuss the challenges and opportunities of multi-stakeholder partnerships for developing new and scaling existing innovations. In small-group discussions, participants examined existing partnerships, shared practical recommendations, and explored how partnerships will support food systems transformation on a global scale.

Achieving healthy diets from sustainable food systems by 2030 – what science, innovation, and actions are needed in Australia?

Convened on 8 June 2021 by Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation (CSIRO).

[This dialogue](#) provided an opportunity for interactive discussion among diverse stakeholders to discuss, debate and identify possible food system futures and the science, innovation, and actions needed by key stakeholders.

What role does food labelling play in helping to shift consumers towards healthier, safe and sustainable consumption?

Convened on 13 July 2021 by the Department of Health.

This dialogue considered the role of food labelling to help shift consumers towards healthier, safe and sustainable consumption. The dialogue featured short presentations from key speakers from government, academia and industry.

Post-Summit

UN Food Systems Coordination Hub

The UN Food Systems Coordination Hub was established in 2022 and is hosted by FAO on behalf of the UN. The Hub's primary role is to support countries to develop further and implement their national agricultural and food systems transformation pathways.

The Hub holds a coordination role that brings together relevant UN agencies, coalitions, international financial institutions, the private sector and other supporting actors to galvanize food systems knowledge and expertise in support of countries' action.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/market-access-trade/un-food-systems-summit-2021>